Three years of the ELIXIR-UK Fellowship

Empowering Minds: Professionalising UK Data Stewardship in Life Sciences

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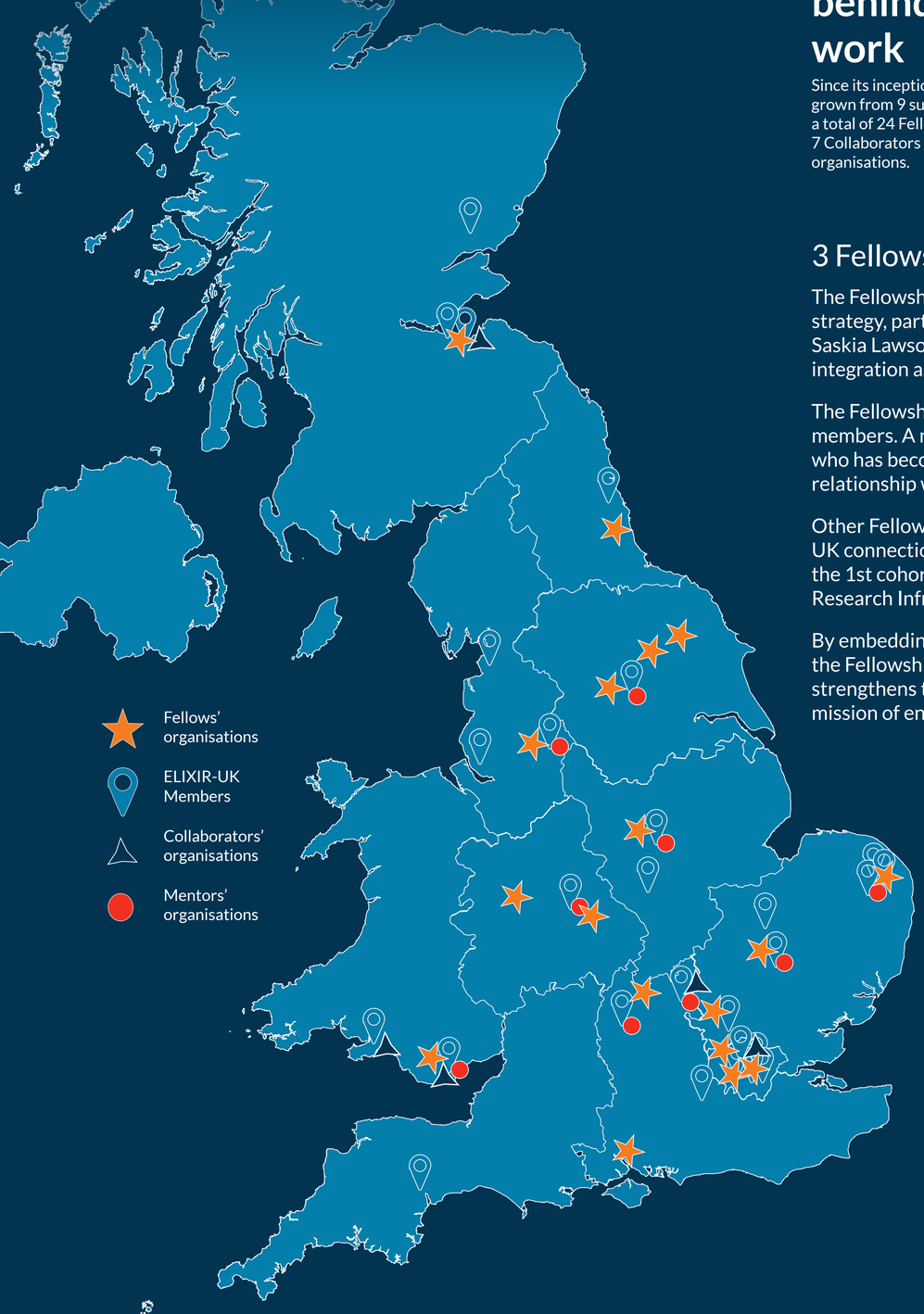
The Fellowship in numbers



The people behind our work

Since its inception, the Fellowship has grown from 9 successful applicants to a total of 24 Fellows, 19 Mentors and 7 Collaborators from 23 different UK organisations.

Fellows ---------- 24
Mentors --------- 10
Collaborators ----- 7
UK Organisations -- 23

3 Fellows leading on ELIXIR activities

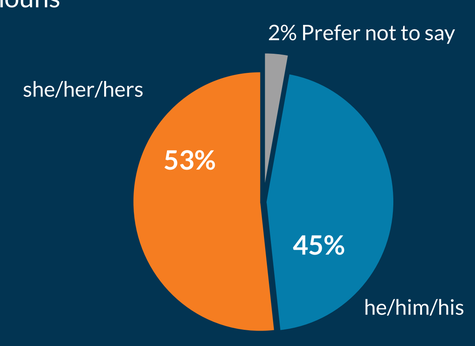
The Fellowship has successfully integrated its Fellows into the broader ELIXIR strategy, particularly within the RDM Community, UK RDM and Training Clubs. Saskia Lawson-Tovey, from the University of Manchester, exemplifies this integration as the co-lead of the ELIXIR-UK Human Data Community.

The Fellowship has also fostered valuable relationships among UK Node members. A notable example is Adam Partridge, from the University of Sheffield, who has become a FAIRsharing Community Champion due to his mentor relationship with Allyson Lister, the FAIRsharing Coordinator.

Other Fellows have also actively engaged with other Nodes, where their ELIXIR-UK connection served as a conduit for collaboration. Emma Karoune, part of the 1st cohort, co-leads the ELIXIR Focus Group on Professionalising careers in Research Infrastructures.

By embedding Fellows into key ELIXIR activities and facilitating relationships, the Fellowship Programme not only empowers individual researchers but also strengthens the collaborative fabric of ELIXIR-UK, driving forward the collective mission of enhancing data stewardship and research infrastructures.

Pronouns



6 different activities

76
RDMbites
Short informative videos (3-5 minutes) to describe basic and specialised aspects of RDM.

17
Training delivered
Bringing the knowledge and expertise to professionals within Fellows' organisations and virtual communities.

13
Courses & Workshops
Developed courses and workshops on basic and specialised topics in an open and reusable format.

5
FAIRytales
Personal stories about working with FAIR and demystifying the data steward role.

10
Sponsored Fellows
Sponsored Fellows to attend conferences and meetings with a focus on FAIR data or capacity building.

15
DMPs
Created exemplary Data Management Plans to aid researchers using the Data Stewardship Wizard, covering a spectrum of data types (e.g. omics, image, questionnaire, simulated data.

14 topics covered

- Agricultural data
- Bioimage data
- Data Management Plans
- Data management essentials
- Equity, Diversity, Inclusion and Justice
- FAIR data essentials
- Guide to FAIRification
- Health data
- Machine learning
- Peatland data
- Plant data
- REDCap
- Sequencing data
- Single-cell data

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ELIXIR ALL HANDS MEETING 2024
UPPSALA, SWEDEN

The project behind the Fellowship

In 2021, ELIXIR-UK was granted a UKRI award for the ELIXIR-UK DaSH project. The University of Bradford leads the project with a delivery team at Cardiff University, the Earlham Institute, the University of Manchester, and the University of Oxford.

The project aims to embed Research Data Management (RDM) know-how into UK universities and institutes by producing and delivering training in Data Stewardship. It focuses on building capacity and professionalising the role of Data Stewards while leveraging the local expertise within diverse UK research-performing organisations.

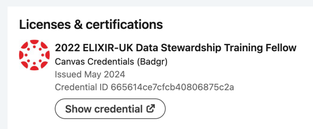
Ultimately, the project aims to create a culture change with a Fellowship of Data Stewards. Fellows will act as ambassadors to embed RDM for the life sciences in their organisations.

What's new

Formally recognising the contributions of all our collaborators and Fellows

We are proud to recognise the invaluable contributions of our Fellows, Collaborators, and Mentors in advancing data stewardship training and enhancing the skills of the UK life sciences community. To formally acknowledge their efforts, we have introduced Canvas badges, thanks to the knowledge-exchange efforts with the EuroBioimaging community. These badges are not just a token of appreciation but also a professional credential, featuring unique codes that can be linked to each individual's LinkedIn profile, enhancing their professional visibility and recognition.

30 Awarded badges



Developing and delivering data management training

The community has developed further training. Courses and FAIR learning pathways are now available on the Galaxy Training Network (GTN).

Several Fellows and Collaborators have worked together in 2024 to deliver 14 courses nationally or locally across the UK in diverse life science data management topics.

Additionally, we actively engaged with our community through hackathons, fostering a collaborative environment for knowledge sharing and skill development.

Integrating our resources in TeSS and expanding its reach and use in the UK

We have ensured that all training materials and events developed and delivered by our Fellows and collaborators are showcased in the ELIXIR Training e-Support System (TeSS).

Our ongoing efforts also include developing a UK-centric TeSS portal to highlight and promote UK-specific training materials and events, ensuring greater accessibility and a targeted reach.

To make this UK-centric portal a reality, we are actively engaging with UK organisations. We are also guiding these institutions on implementing Bioschemas markup on their websites, which allows their resources to be automatically discovered and registered in TeSS, thereby enhancing the visibility and utility of their training materials and events.

Demystifying FAIR and data stewardship: FAIRytales

We are dedicated to simplifying the principles of FAIR data, how FAIR works in practice and several data management key topics through our FAIRytales. This effort aims to make data management more accessible and understandable to all members of the life sciences community through personal user stories or friendly, informal guides.

Our stories, featuring the experiences of Fellows and other collaborators across the UK, also aim to demystify the role of data stewardship and how data management best practices are being implemented in different UK organisations.

Enhancing Data Stewardship Wizard use in the UK

Our efforts to enhance the use of the DSW in the UK are multifaceted. We are importing UK funder DMP templates into DSW, supporting the new Funding Service website, where DMPs are now a required component of every application.

Additionally, we are investigating how UK institutions and universities can host local instances of DSW, which would provide them with greater control and customisation capabilities.

We are also gathering user stories to showcase how DSW can be tailored to meet the specific needs of different institutions, funding calls and governance structures.

Scan me to visit the Fellowship site and its community and resources
fellowship.elixiruknode.org

6 *About UK Node*
72 *About BioFAIR*

Visit our ELIXIR-UK Node posters for more information